

Tracking and Reforming

This session is focused on teaching different driving techniques and integrating them into offensive play.

Overview

Pre-Session: Off Skates Warm-up 5-10 Minutes

Lightly making sure that the joints still work.

Focus is **not** on building strength, cardio or endurance, just on limbering up. Do 5 to 10 reps of each, on each side.

- Toe taps + one leg light squats
- Arm, shoulder and neck stretches
- Opening and closing hip rotations
- Knee raise to superman
- Cross chest knee raises
- Butt kicks, high knees, side shuffles

Warm Up - 10 Minutes

We will be doing a reasonable amount of lateral work in this session, so we modify our warm up accordingly.

- Sticky skating - Regular, Figure 8, low
- Weaves focusing on 180 degree turns
- Crossover-Carves
- One foot lateral glides
- Cardio - 1 minute forwards, 1 minute backwards, 1 minute anti-derby, 1 minute anti-derby backwards

Followed by any dynamic stretching needed.

Tracking - 10 minutes

In pairs one skater doing weave and carves, the other doing backwards tracking footwork. For more details see [here](#)

Followed by 'derby stops' around the track.

One Foot Blocking - 5 minutes

Warming up edges with some contact. One skater driving, the other skater blocking on one foot. This will be a useful technique for resisting the driving drills to come.

Drives - 25 Minutes

This is a revision on the driving session. Roll through each type of drive in a few minutes.

- Hip drive starting engaged
- Hip drive from one to two feet
- Shoulder drive
- Low shoulder drive- with a focus on shoulder to butt cheek driving where possible.
- Shoulder drive into Chest drive
- Shelf drive starting engaged.

Blockers should attempt to resist, especially using the one foot blocking from earlier. Blockers should act as if they were a butt in a wall - hence they cannot simply avoid the hit without displacing themselves

The offence should be seeking to move the blocker at least one lane, but ideally to take them off the track.

Three Wall Driving

The goal now is to have the three wall use these drives.

- - Driving the jammer
- - Pocketing the jammer
- - Hit out and reform - cutting one friendly.

360 Offence - 20 minutes

Mixing up the drives now, start with an offence engaged in a three wall. For this drill we will also add a jammer. Walls should work on a drive, hit out and reform. Offence should try to rescue their jammer.

- Run the 360 offence drill - 30 seconds to 1 minute per offence, then a rest.
- Move onto skewering practice.

This is a higher intensity drill, so cycling skaters for a rest is a good idea.

Drill Notes

Drill: Brace Tracking

This drill mimics brace footwork, and encourages jammers to juke the final blocker rather than attempt to charge them.

A drill to be performed in pairs. One skater takes the role of the blocker, the other of the jammer.

The blocker's goal is to use backwards one foot laterals to keep chest-facing the jammer.

The jammer's goal is to use only weaves or carves to throw the blocker off - not to actually pass the blocker

As both skaters are in motion, this drill should move around the track.

Dynamic Take

Skaters skate around the track in pairs, one in front, and one behind. On the whistle both skaters need to come to a stop.

The trainer can vary up the stops.

Progression: Rather than stopping behind the other skater, take their place.

Drill: Derby Stops

Around the track, the goal is to approach a line, and perform a sharp turn around toe-stop without going out, then to accelerate back towards the centre before taking the other line.

Side shuffles and grape-vines can be incorporated, mimicing a jamming passing movement.

Drill: Hip Drive

This drill requires pairs of skaters.

Starting engaged, one skater is driving the other blocking, with both skaters starting in the middle of the track.

The driving skater should attempt to use their thigh and hip to push the other skater off the track. The skater being driven should attempt to hold their position (rather than simply skating away).

The core idea for the pushing skater is to collapse the leg of the other blocker - once their knee is pointing towards the edge of the track it is much easier to push them in that direction. To achieve this the block must begin legally - with either the hip or the thigh making contact. The skater can then apply pressure through the thigh to turn the blocker's leg. If the drive is initiated with the thigh, then the hip can be swung in as an additional hit during the drive.

Practice in pairs, and rotate skaters where possible - driving is best practiced against a wide range of different opponents. Also don't forget to practice driving to both the inside and outside.

Progressions: A natural progression to just hip and thigh engagement is to blur the line with a shoulder drive - engaging that too

Drill: Shoulder Drive

This drill requires pairs of skaters.

Starting engaged, one skater is driving the other blocking, with both skaters starting in the middle of the track.

The driving skater should attempt to use their shoulder to drive the other blocker. The skater being driven should attempt to hold their position (rather than simply skating away).

In this case, the shoulder can be used to partially lift the other blocker. The idea is to set up in the armpit or ribs of the other blocker, and leverage from this position. As friction requires that they're applying weight into the floor, this drive effectively negates the blockers ability to engage their edges with one leg.

Practice in pairs, and rotate skaters where possible - driving is best practiced against a wide range of different opponents. Also don't forget to practice driving to both the inside and outside.

Drill: Low Shoulder Drive

This drill requires pairs of skaters.

Starting engaged, one skater is driving the other blocking, with both skaters starting in the middle of the track.

The driving skater should attempt to use their shoulder to drive the other blocker. The skater being driven should attempt to hold their position (rather than simply skating away).

In this case, the shoulder can be used to partially rotate the other blocker. The driving skater should set their shoulder up next to the butt cheek of the blocker. Using this as a fulcrum they can then apply pressure to rotate the blocker. Once the blocker is rotated, they've effectively had their feet turned, as in the hip drive, and can now be pushed more easily.

For this secondary drive, try moving from the shoulder drive into a chest drive to corale the blocker off the track.

Practice in pairs, and rotate skaters where possible - driving is best practiced against a wide range of different opponents. Also don't forget to practice driving to both the inside and outside.

Drill: Chest Drive

This drill requires pairs of skaters.

Starting engaged, one skater is driving the other blocking, with both skaters starting in the middle of the track.

The driving skater should attempt to use their chest to drive the other blocker. The skater being driven should attempt to hold their position (rather than simply skating away).

The idea of this drive is to push from a chest-on-chest position, using a combination of the direction of play, and the momentum from an initial, alternative drive to get the skater moving.

This is best started from a shoulder drive, either low or regular, then ends in a chest drive. Keeping one leg down-track from the blocker prevents them from rotating in that direction, ideally getting them onto toe-stops further limits their ability to get out of the situation, which is helped by lifting them with the initial shoulder drive.

Practice in pairs, and rotate skaters where possible - driving is best practiced against a wide range of different opponents. Also don't forget to practice driving to both the inside and outside.

Drill: Shelf Drive

This drill requires pairs of skaters.

Starting engaged, one skater is driving the other blocking, with both skaters starting in the middle of the track.

The driving skater should attempt to shelf and drive the other blocker. The skater being driven should attempt to hold their position (rather than simply skating away).

This is a mix of the hip and shoulder drive. Setting up with a leg placed laterally beneath the blocker, and a shoulder in the same position as the shoulder drive, the idea is to perform a lateral directly into the blocker. It is important to not engage the toe stop under the target blocker, as this will burn off the momentum of the drive. Additionally it is important to start the engagement with either the hip, or the shoulder - starting with the thigh under the other blocker is a back block if any impact is achieved, and the purpose of the drive is to cause impact.

Using a 'skateboard' lateral push, or a toe-stop push continue to drive the other blocker off the track. The shoulder and thigh set up prevents the blocker from getting low - limiting the friction they can generate to resist the push.

Practice in pairs, and rotate skaters where possible - driving is best practiced against a wide range of different opponents. Also don't forget to practice driving to both the inside and outside.

Three Wall Driving

In groups of four. Three blockers, one jammer. Jammer works on moving between lanes 1.5 and 3.5, while the three-wall tries to drive the jammer into a pocket. Walls should focus on not rotating and not hitting out. Brace should try to be colinear with the jammer. More experienced blockers may attempt to wrap the jammer.

Progression The first progression is to request that the jammer stops facilitating the drill.

Drill: Three Wall Pocketing

This drill extends from a three wall drive. Starting in lane two or three, the jammer should be engaged with the wall. One of the blockers should then extend backwards slightly and attempt to either shelve or hook the jammer, then drive them towards the opposite line.

As they approach the line the brace should double on the line, and the butt on the line should remain square.

The driving blocker should drop and expose their back towards the in - presenting an illegal contact zone. Ideally they would also extend one leg backwards, limiting the jammer's mobility in that direction.

The wall should then hold this position while inching forward (to prevent a stopped block) for as long as possible, hitting the jammer out only if it is required.

Drill: Three Wall Cutting One Friendly

This drill extends from a three wall pocket. The idea here is to perform a bigger clearance of the jammer than is usually performed with the blocker intentionally taking themselves out. The goal is then for the wall to reform in a controlled fashion without incurring a penalty.

Starting with the jammer pocketed on the line, the driving blocker should drive the jammer out, taking themselves with the jammer. One of the blockers (either the butt or the brace) should then perform a run-back, while the other maintains pack definition.

The initiating blocker can now re-enter in front of the blocker performing a run-back (cutting one friendly blocker). They can then join the other blocker at the back in a two-wall.

Their next goal is to perform a two-wall catch, then reform with their third blocker as a three wall and repeat the drill.

Progressions: Rather than starting from a pocket, begin with the jammer in the centre of the track. Alternatively, or additionally, perform this drill with two packs, and avoid causing a destruction on the run back.

Skewering

This drill requires four skaters, three blockers and an opposing offence.

The blockers begin set up as a three-wall. The offence's goal is to hit one of the butts into the other, then to launch into the brace.

- Queue up from the inside or the outside of the track, lining the blockers up.
- The initial hit into drive is to impart momentum onto the first blocker, allowing their own force to drive them into the second.
- Once that blocker is no longer making contact with the offence, the next move is to take the brace.

The initial drive may be any of the hip, shoulder, chest or shelved drives. When hitting the brace consider the advantages of either covering the same line as the initial approach, or setting up a threading situation.

A video can be found towards the end of here.

360 Offence

This drill requires four skaters, three blockers and an opposing offence.

The original drill uses two to three different drives, I'll be updating this to four.

- Hip drive using lateral pushes
- Shoulder to hip drive
- Chest drive
- Shelf drive using lateral pushes

The goal is to chain these drives together to dismember a wall.

The offence starts in the centre of the wall, where the jammer would normally be.

The offence should then attempt to drive one of the butts, switch and drive the brace then disengage and reset to drive the other butt towards the centre of the track before switching to again driving the brace. Then reset in the centre and repeat in the opposite direction. A video can be found [here](#).

Progressions

As an offence progression - drive both butts together off the track as part of the final movement as in the skewering drill.

As a natural progression, add a jammer.